

the Traveller's Prayer — صلاة الطريق • תפילת הדרך

Hebrew, transcribed into Arabic letters, with the Semitic cognates. Companion sheet to the narrated lesson. Stress the **last** syllable of every word.

READING KEY — FIVE BORROWED LETTERS

פ = v

ג = hard g (as in “go”, never a jeem)

פ = p

טס = ts — one sound, as in “cats”

כח = kh (older reading: ح)

ע = usually silent in modern Israeli Hebrew

THE DECODER RING — SIX CONSONANT CORRESPONDENCES

HEBREW	ARABIC	EXAMPLE	NOTE
shin ש	sin س	שָׁלוֹם → سَلَام	peace — the most famous pair
tsadi צ	ṣād ص	צָעַד → صَعِدَ	step / climb — same motion, different aim
zayin ז	dhāl ذ	אָחַז → أَخَذَ	to seize — Arabic kept the tooth
het ח	ḥā' ح	חַיִּים → حَيَاة	life — Mizrahi Hebrew says it as you do
ayin ע	‘ayn ع	עוֹלָם → عَالَم	world — yours is the conservative reading
qof ק	qāf ق	קוֹל → قَوْل	voice / utterance

THE PRAYER — TEN LINES

יְהִי רָצוֹן מִלְּפָנֶיךָ, אֲדוֹנָי אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
יְהִי רִאשׁוֹן מִלְּפָנֶיךָ, אֲדוֹנָי אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ

yehi ratzon milfaneicha, Adonai Eloheinu ve-Elohei avoteinu
May it be Your will, our Lord and God of our fathers

שְׁתוּלִיכֵנוּ לְשָׁלוֹם, וְתַצְעִידֵנוּ לְשָׁלוֹם, וְתַדְרִיכֵנוּ לְשָׁלוֹם
שְׁתוּלִיכֵנוּ לְשָׁלוֹם, וְתַצְעִידֵנוּ לְשָׁלוֹם, וְתַדְרִיכֵנוּ לְשָׁלוֹם

she-tolichenu le-shalom, ve-tatz'idenu le-shalom, ve-tadrichenu le-shalom
that You lead us in peace, make us step in peace, guide us in peace

וְתַגִּיעֵנוּ לְמַחֲזֵ חֲפְצֵנוּ, לְחַיִּים וּלְשִׂמְחָה וּלְשָׁלוֹם
וְתַגִּיעֵנוּ לְמַחֲזֵ חֲפְצֵנוּ, לְחַיִּים וּלְשִׂמְחָה וּלְשָׁלוֹם

ve-tagi'enu li-mchoz cheftzenu, le-chayim ul-simcha ul-shalom
and bring us to the haven of our desire — for life, joy and peace

וְתַצִּילֵנוּ מִכָּף כָּל אוֹיֵב וְאוֹרֵב וְלִסְטִים וְחַיּוֹת רָעוֹת בַּדֶּרֶךְ
וְתַצִּילֵנוּ מִכָּף כָּל אוֹיֵב וְאוֹרֵב וְלִסְטִים וְחַיּוֹת רָעוֹת בַּדֶּרֶךְ

ve-tatzilenu mikaf kol oyev ve-orev ve-listim ve-chayot ra'ot ba-derech
and save us from the palm of every enemy, ambusher, bandit and wild beast on the road

וּמִכָּל מִינֵי פְּרַעְנִיּוֹת הַמִּתְרַגְּשׁוֹת לְבוֹא לְעוֹלָם
וּמִכָּל מִינֵי פְּרַעְנִיּוֹת הַמִּתְרַגְּשׁוֹת לְבוֹא לְעוֹלָם

u-mikol minei pur'aniyot ha-mitragshot lavo la-olam
and from all kinds of calamity rushing to come into the world

וְתִשְׁלַח בְּרָכָה בְּכָל מַעֲשֵׂה יָדֶינוּ⁶

فَتَشْلُخْ بِرَاحَا بِخَوْل مَعْسِيَه يَادَيْنُو

ve-tishlach bracha bechol ma'aseh yadeinu
and send blessing on all the work of our hands

וְתִתְּנֵנִי לַחֵן וּלְחֶסֶד וּלְרַחֲמִים, בְּעֵינֶיךָ וּבְעֵינֵי כָל רוֹאִינוּ⁷

فَتَتِنِنِي لِحَيْن وَلُحْسِد وَلُرَحْمِيم، بَعَيْنِخَا أَوْعَيْنِيَه خَوْل رُوَيْنُو

ve-titneni le-chen ul-chesed ul-rachamim, be-einecha uv-einei chol ro'einu
and grant me grace, kindness and mercy — in Your eyes and the eyes of all who see us

וְתִשְׁמַע קוֹל תַּחֲנוּנֵינוּ⁸

فَتِشْمَعْ كَوْل تَخْنُونِينُو

ve-tishma kol tachanuneinu
and hear the voice of our supplication

כִּי אֵל שׁוֹמֵעַ תְּפִלָּה וְתַחֲנוּן אַתָּה⁹

كِي اِيل شوميع تَفِلَا فِتَخْنُون اَتَا

ki El shomea tefilla ve-tachanun ata
for You are a God who hears prayer and supplication

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה אֲדוֹנָי, שׁוֹמֵעַ תְּפִלָּה¹⁰

باروخ اَتَا اَدُوناي، شوميع تَفِلَا

Baruch ata Adonai, shomea tefilla
Blessed are You, Lord, who hears prayer

THE COGNATES, WORD BY WORD

HEBREW	ARABIC	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
תְּפִלַּת הַדֶּרֶךְ	إِضَافَةٌ	prayer-OF the-road — a construct chain
ה	أَنَّ	the — same job, same position
רָצוֹן	رِضْوَانٌ	will · divine good-pleasure
מִלִּפְנֵיךָ	مِنْ لَدُنْكَ	from before You — four pieces
אֱלֹהֵינוּ	إِلَهُنَا	our God — root and suffix both
אֲבוֹתֵינוּ	آبَاؤُنَا	our fathers
לְשָׁלוֹם	لِسَلَامٍ	in peace — even the prefix matches
וְתַצְעִידֵנוּ	صَعِدَ	make us step ← the climbing root
דֶּרֶךְ	أَدْرَكَ . دَرَكٌ	road ↔ to reach along a way
מָחַד	مَأْخَذٌ	haven — "the place you take hold of"
שִׂמְחָה	سَمَاحَةٌ	joy ↔ open-heartedness
מִכַּף כָּל	مِنْ كَفِّ كُلِّ	from the palm of every...
לִסְטִים	مِثْلَ قَانُونٍ وَإِنْبِلِيس	bandits — a Greek loanword, ληστές
חַיּוֹת	حَيَوَانَاتٌ	beasts — "living things", in both

לְעוֹלָם	إِلَى الْعَالَمِ	into the world
בְּרָכָה	بِرَكَّةَ	blessing — nothing moved at all
בְּרָךְ	بَرَكَ • مَبْرَكَ	the KNEE — what blessing is built from
בְּכָל • יְדֵינוּ	بِكُلِّ • أَيْدِينَا	in every... • our hands
חַן	حَنَانٌ • الْحَنَان	grace, tenderness
חֶסֶד	حَسَدٌ	kindness ↔ envy — one root, opposite ends
רַחֲמִים	رَحْمَةً	mercy
רֶחֶם	رَحِمَ	the WOMB — the root under "mercy"
עֵינֶיךָ • רֹאֵינוּ	عَيْنَيْكَ • رَأَى	your eyes • those who see
וְתִשְׁמַע	وَتَسْمَعَ	and may You hear — same root, same prefix
תַּחֲנוּן	تَحْنُنُ	supplication — same root AND same pattern
יִשְׁמַעֲלֵה	إِسْمَاعِيل	"God hears" — a sentence, not a name
צְלוּתָהּ	صَلَاةٌ	borrowed from Aramaic ṣəlōtā — "to bow"
אַתָּה	أَنْتَ	you — Hebrew swallowed the n
בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה	مُبَارَكٌ أَنْتَ	blessed are You
שׁוֹמַעַ תְּפִלָּה	سَامِعُ الصَّلَاةِ	who hears prayer

TWO GRAMMAR NOTES, AND ONE ROAD PRAYER

The title is an idafa. תְּפִלַּת הַדֶּרֶךְ is a construct chain — *prayer-of the-road* — exactly your إضافة, and הַ is your אֵל. Hebrew swallowed a nun. אַתָּה “you” was once *anta*, your أَنْت; the n assimilated into the t, and the dot written inside that letter is its tombstone.

The Muslim road prayer, for comparison.

اللَّهُمَّ إِنَّا نَسْأَلُكَ فِي سَفَرِنَا هَذَا الْبِرَّ وَالتَّقْوَى
أَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ وَغْثِ السَّفَرِ وَكَآبَةِ الْمَنْظَرِ وَسُوءِ الْمُنْقَلَبِ

One fears the hardship of the road, the gloom of the sight, a bad homecoming. The other fears the enemy, the ambusher, the bandit, the wild animal. Both were written by people who knew the road was where you got killed.

Companion to the narrated lesson “Tefilat HaDerech — the Traveller’s Prayer, in Arabic letters”. Hebrew text is the standard siddur wording; אֲדוּנִי is written here as אָדוּנִי, which is how it is read aloud.